

CLAUDE COWORK MASTERCLASS

for Professionals + Claude AI No Code

Master Claude Cowork for Real Work, Documents and Agentic AI Workflows — No Coding Required

Complete Training Handout

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Running Example Throughout This Course:

Pashun Sports T-Shirts — Breaking Into the 2026 Football World Cup Market

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What Is an AI Agent? (And Why Cowork Is One)

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Before we install anything, we need to understand the shift that makes Cowork different from every AI tool you've used before. This lesson covers AI agents — what they are, how they think, and why Cowork is the most accessible version of this technology for knowledge workers.

Generative AI vs AI Agents — What's the Difference?

Most people's experience of AI is generative AI: you type a message, AI generates a response. It produces text, images, or code in reply to a single prompt. Then it stops. It does not do anything next.

An AI agent is different. An agent reasons, plans, and executes — autonomously, across multiple steps, using tools — to reach a goal you define. It doesn't stop after one reply. It works.

	Generative AI (e.g. Claude Chat)	AI Agent (e.g. Claude Cowork)
What it does	Responds to your message	Plans and executes towards your goal
How it works	One prompt → one output	Multi-step reasoning → actions → result
File access	Only if you upload	Direct access to your local files and apps
Autonomy	None — waits for your next message	Runs independently, loops you in as needed
Best for	Writing, Q&A, drafting, analysis	Organising, reporting, automating, executing

Key Concepts in AI Agents

Autonomy

An agent can work without being directed at every step. You set the goal. It figures out the sequence of actions needed to reach it. Cowork shows you the plan first — you approve — then runs it without interruption.

Reasoning

Agents don't just follow instructions literally. They reason about what needs to happen. If you ask Cowork to 'organise the supplier files', it looks at what's there, infers categories, proposes a structure, and applies it. It thinks before it acts.

Tool Use

Agents use tools — file systems, web browsers, connectors to apps like Gmail or Google Drive — to get things done. Cowork's tools include your local folders, the web via Chrome, and 38+ app connectors. The agent picks the right tool for each step automatically.

Memory

Agents can retain context across a session. Cowork remembers what you're working on, what files it's already seen, and what decisions were made earlier in a task — so you don't have to repeat yourself.

Goal-Directed Behaviour

Unlike a chatbot that responds to the last message, an agent stays focused on the original goal. Even across many steps, Cowork keeps asking: am I closer to the outcome the user defined?

 Cowork Agents vs Other AI Agents

	Cowork (Anthropic)	Manus	OpenAI Operator
Best for	Knowledge work, files, documents	Complex research & web tasks	Browser-based web tasks
Runs on	Your desktop — local	Cloud	Cloud
File access	Direct local access	Via upload	Web only
Setup	Desktop app + QR pair	Browser/web	Browser
Audience	Non-technical professionals	Power users / devs	General / enterprise

 **Cowork is the only major agentic AI that runs directly on your desktop, with direct access to your local files, and works without any coding setup. That's what makes it uniquely powerful for the knowledge worker who isn't a developer.**

Demo — Agent Thinking vs Chat Thinking

The same goal, two different tools

Goal: Turn a folder of order files into a weekly sales report.

With Claude Chat (generative AI):

- You upload each file manually.
- You paste the data or describe it.
- Claude writes a report based on what you gave it.
- You copy the output. You format it. You save it yourself.

With Claude Cowork (AI agent):

- You write: 'Read /PashunSports/Orders/Week18/ and produce a weekly sales report saved to /PashunSports/Reports/'
- Cowork reads all the files, analyses the data, writes the report, and saves it — without you doing anything else.

Same goal. One took 20 minutes and several manual steps. The other took 30 seconds and one brief.

Summary

- Generative AI responds. AI agents plan, reason, and execute.
- Cowork is an AI agent — it works autonomously across multiple steps to reach a goal
- Key agent concepts: autonomy, reasoning, tool use, memory, goal-directed behaviour
- Cowork is uniquely desktop-native, giving it direct file access that cloud agents can't match
- You stay in control — Cowork shows its plan and loops you in before significant actions

Your Turn

Think of one task you do every week that involves multiple steps — collecting data, processing it, writing a summary. Write it down. This is your first candidate for a Cowork agent task. We'll build it later in the course.



End of Lesson: What Is an AI Agent? (And Why Cowork Is One)

Which Plan Do You Need For Cowork?

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Cowork is not available on every Claude plan. Before you install anything, you need to know which plan unlocks it — so you don't hit a wall mid-lesson.

 Plans change regularly. Always check claude.com/pricing for the latest. The information below is correct as of April 2026, Version 1.4758.0.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Cowork Access	Unlocks the agentic desktop agent	Knowing which plan you need before starting — no wasted time

The Plans

Plan	Price	Cowork Access	Best For
Free	£0/month	 No Cowork	Exploring Claude Chat only
Pro	£17–20/month	 Full Cowork — all features	This course; daily professional use
Max	£80–160/month	 Full Cowork + higher usage	Power users running Cowork all day
Team	\$25–30/seat	 Full Cowork + admin controls	Teams deploying Cowork together
Enterprise	Custom	 Full Cowork + RBAC, SIEM, spend limits	Large organisations

Which Plan Is This Course Designed For?

This course requires Pro plan or above. Everything in the outline — task execution, plugins, Skills, Dispatch, Computer Use, live dashboards — requires at least Pro.

If you are on the Free plan, you will not have access to Cowork. Upgrade at claude.ai/upgrade before continuing.

How Usage Works in Cowork

Claude does not give you a fixed number of Cowork tasks per day. Usage is session-based. Heavy Cowork tasks (reading many files, running long workflows) consume more of your session than simple tasks.

- Pro gives you 5× more usage than Free — sufficient for daily knowledge work in Cowork
- Max gives 5× or 20× more than Pro — for users running Cowork all day across many files
- Usage resets periodically — check claude.com/pricing for current limits

✓ Summary

- Cowork requires Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise — Free plan has no Cowork access
- Pro at £17–20/month gives you everything in this course
- Check claude.com/pricing for the latest — plans update regularly

🎯 Your Turn

Check your current Claude plan. If you're on Free, go to claude.ai/upgrade and choose Pro before the next lesson. If you're on Pro or above, you're ready.

✓ End of Lesson: Which Plan Do You Need For Cowork?

How To Install The Claude Desktop App And Set Up Cowork

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Cowork lives inside the Claude Desktop app — not the browser. You cannot use Cowork on claude.ai in your web browser. This lesson gets you from zero to your first Cowork session ready to run.

⚠ Cowork is desktop-only. macOS and Windows (x64) are both supported as of April 2026.

Intel Macs and Windows ARM64 are not supported. The desktop app must stay open while Cowork runs — closing it ends the session.

Cowork downloads a Linux virtual machine (~2GB) on first launch. Allow time for this download.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Claude Desktop + Cowork	Install and launch the agentic desktop environment	Getting from 'I have a Claude account' to 'Cowork is ready to run tasks'

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Go to claude.ai/download in your browser and download the Claude Desktop app for macOS or Windows.
2. Open the downloaded file and install it as you would any desktop application.
3. Sign in with your Claude account. You need Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise.
4. The first time you open Cowork, it will download a Linux virtual machine (~2GB). Wait for this to complete.
5. Once signed in, look at the left sidebar. You will see three tabs: Chat, Cowork, and Code. Click Cowork.
6. The Dispatch view opens. This is your Cowork home. To start a task, click the + icon or type directly into the task input at the bottom.



Demo — First-Time Setup for Pashun Sports

Step 1 — Download and Install

Go to claude.ai/download. Download for your OS. Install and sign in with your Pro (or higher) account.

Step 2 — Wait for Cowork to Initialise

Click the Cowork tab. The first time you do this, Cowork downloads and configures a sandboxed environment. This takes a few minutes depending on your connection. You will see a progress indicator.

Step 3 — Grant Folder Access When Asked

When you first assign a task that involves your files, Cowork will ask which folder to work with. You select the folder at that point. You do not need to pre-configure folders before running your first task.

Step 4 — Run a Simple Verification Task

In the Cowork task input, type:

```
Create a text file in my Documents folder called  
'cowork_test.txt' containing today's date and the  
words 'Cowork is working correctly.'
```

Cowork will ask which folder to access. Select your Documents folder. If you see the file appear, setup is complete.



No files in your folder yet? That is fine at this stage.

The folder access prompt appears when you run your first file-related task.

We will set up proper Pashun Sports folder structure in the next section.



Summary

- Download Claude Desktop from claude.ai/download — Cowork does not work in a browser
- Click Cowork in the left sidebar (alongside Chat and Code)
- Cowork downloads a VM on first launch — allow a few minutes
- Folder access is granted when you first run a task that needs it, not during setup
- The desktop app must stay open while Cowork runs



Your Turn

Install Claude Desktop. Sign in, click Cowork, let the environment download. Run the verification task above to confirm Cowork is working. You don't need any specific files yet.



End of Lesson: How To Install The Claude Desktop App And Set Up Cowork

How Cowork Is Different From Chat And Claude Code

Intro — What We're Doing Today

There are now three ways to use Claude: Chat, Cowork, and Code. They look similar but do fundamentally different things. Getting this right means using the right tool for every job.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Chat vs Cowork vs Code	Understand which mode to use and when	Using Chat for tasks that need Cowork, or wondering why the result isn't saved anywhere

The Three Modes — At a Glance

	Chat	Cowork	Claude Code
What it does	Generates responses in conversation	Plans & executes multi-step tasks on your machine	Plans & executes multi-step coding tasks in your terminal
File access	Only uploaded files	Direct local files in granted folders	Direct local files — entire codebase
Autonomous?	No — one message, one reply	Yes — runs steps, loops you in at key points	Yes — runs steps, loops you in at key points
Interface	Browser or Desktop Chat tab	Desktop Cowork tab — visual task UI	Terminal or IDE (VS Code, JetBrains)
Cowork vs Code	—	Same agentic architecture as Code, optimised for knowledge work (files, docs, research)	Same agentic architecture as Cowork, optimised for software development (code, builds, PRs)
Plan required	Pro for Claude Code / Skills	Pro and above	Pro and above + Node.js + terminal
Best for	Writing, Q&A, research, quick tasks	File org, reports, automation, multi-app workflows	Coding, refactoring, builds, debugging



Cowork and Claude Code share the same agentic engine.

The key difference: Cowork runs in a visual desktop interface and is optimised for knowledge work (documents, files, research, automation). Claude Code runs in the terminal and is optimised for software development.

If you can describe the task without using the word 'code' — it probably belongs in Cowork.



Demo — Right Tool for Each Pashun Sports Task

Task 1 — Chat

You want to write product copy for a new World Cup fan tee called 'Golden Boot'.

→ Use Chat. Quick writing task. No file access or multi-step execution needed.

Task 2 — Cowork

You have 60 Pashun Sports order CSVs from this week. You need them combined, analysed, and turned into a sales report saved to your Reports folder.

→ Use Cowork. Multi-step, requires local files, produces a saved output.

Task 3 — Claude Code

You need to add a custom discount calculator to your ecommerce website's checkout page.

→ Use Claude Code. Reads your codebase, writes and edits code files, runs in your terminal.



Summary

- Chat generates. Cowork and Code execute.
- Cowork and Code share the same AI architecture — the difference is interface and specialisation
- Cowork: knowledge work, files, documents. Code: software development, terminal.
- All three live in Claude Desktop — left sidebar tabs
- When in doubt: if the task involves files but not code, use Cowork



Your Turn

List the three most time-consuming tasks in your own work or business. Which would Chat handle? Which needs Cowork? Which needs Code? You don't need to use the Pashun Sports example — use your actual work.



End of Lesson: How Cowork Is Different From Chat And Claude Code

How To Think In Outcomes, Not Prompts

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Most people approach Cowork the same way they approach Chat — with a one-line message. Cowork needs an outcome brief: what does done look like, what files are involved, what are the rules, what is the output. This lesson teaches you the format that gets results.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Outcome-Based Tasking	Frame tasks as goals with a clear end state	Vague instructions that stall, or outputs that don't match what you needed

Demo — Prompt vs Outcome: Pashun Sports Edition

The Prompt Approach (what most people do)

```
Sort my files.
```

Result: Cowork asks clarifying questions, or produces something that doesn't match what you needed.

The Outcome Approach

```
I want my /PashunSports/Orders/2026/ folder organised so I can  
find orders fast.
```

```
Please:
```

- Group files by month (Jan, Feb, Mar, etc.)
- Rename each file to: YYYY-MM-DD_OrderID_CustomerName
- Flag any files that don't follow this naming pattern
- Create a summary CSV listing all files with their new names
saved to /PashunSports/Reports/OrderIndex_Apr2026.csv

```
Show me your plan before making any changes.
```


The Outcome Formula

 **Outcome = What done looks like + Which files/folders + Rules and constraints + Output file name and path + 'Show me the plan first'**

You don't need to tell Cowork how to do each step. Tell it what finished looks like.

Pashun Sports Example — World Cup Launch Brief

I need a product brief document for our 2026 World Cup launch range.

Source files: /PashunSports/Products/WorldCup2026/

(contains spec sheets, design notes, and pricing CSVs)

Output: A single Word document saved to /PashunSports/Marketing/
called 'WorldCupLaunch_Brief_Apr2026.docx'

Include:

- List of all products with names, SKUs, prices, and target markets
- Top 3 hero products (flag these from the pricing CSV)
- Suggested launch order by territory (UK, Brazil, Argentina)

Tone: confident, direct, business-ready. Max 500 words.

Show me the plan first. Don't create the file until I approve.



Summary

- Cowork executes towards outcomes — not back-and-forth conversations
- Always include: end state, which files/folders, rules, output file name, 'show me the plan first'
- The more specific the output definition, the less Cowork interrupts you
- You can always refine mid-task — Cowork loops you in before significant actions

Your Turn

Pick one task you do manually every week in your own business or project. Write it as an outcome brief: end state, files involved, rules, output format. Don't run it yet — just write the brief.

End of Lesson: How To Think In Outcomes, Not Prompts

How To Grant Folder Access So Claude Can Read, Edit, And Create Files

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Cowork can only act on files in folders you have explicitly selected. Nothing outside those folders is visible or touchable. This lesson shows you when and how folder access is granted, and how to manage it.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Folder Access	Grant Cowork read/write access to specific local folders	Cowork saying it can't find files, or accidentally giving access to sensitive directories

When Does Folder Access Happen?

Cowork asks for folder access when you run a task that requires it — not during setup. When Cowork needs to read or write a file and no folder has been granted yet, it prompts you to select one.

You can also manage folder permissions directly in Settings:

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop → click your initials (bottom-left) → Settings.
2. Click 'Cowork' in the left menu.
3. Here you can set Global instructions (standing instructions for every Cowork session).
4. Folder permissions are managed in your operating system. If you accidentally shared the wrong folder, you can revoke access via Settings → Folder Permissions.
5. On macOS: System Settings → Privacy & Security → Files and Folders — remove Claude Desktop from any folder you want to revoke.
6. On Windows: you can re-run the folder selection and choose different directories.

Recommended Folder Structure for Pashun Sports

Before we run file-based tasks, set up a dedicated folder structure. This keeps Cowork's access clean and your outputs organised.

```
/PashunSports/  
  
/Orders/    ← Order CSVs, invoice PDFs, returns  
  
/Products/  ← Product specs, design files, SKU lists  
  
/Suppliers/ ← Supplier contacts, invoices, pricing sheets  
  
/Reports/   ← Output from Cowork — weekly reports, summaries  
  
/Marketing/ ← Social copy, email drafts, campaign assets  
  
/WorldCup2026/ ← World Cup launch materials
```

Create this structure on your computer now. Even with empty folders, Cowork can begin adding files as tasks run.



Demo — First File Task for Pashun Sports

Starting With an Empty Folder

You have just created the `/PashunSports/Reports/` folder. It is empty. Let's use Cowork to create our first file there.

```
Create a setup confirmation file in my /PashunSports/ folder.  
  
Create a file called 'README.txt' containing:  
  
- Today's date  
  
- The text: 'Pashun Sports Cowork workspace initialised.'  
  
- A list of the subfolders we'll use:  
  
  Orders, Products, Suppliers, Reports, Marketing, WorldCup2026  
  
Save it directly in /PashunSports/
```

When Cowork asks for folder access, select your `/PashunSports/` folder. This grants access to

all subfolders within it. You only need to do this once.

What To Grant and What Not To Grant

- Grant: folders that contain the files Cowork will work with
- Do not grant: your entire home directory, Desktop, Downloads unless specifically needed
- Do not grant: folders containing passwords, banking details, or sensitive personal data

 **Cowork asks for your approval before significant actions — but it does have read access to everything in granted folders.**

Be intentional about which folders you select. You can always add more when a task needs them.

Summary

- Folder access is prompted when a task needs it — not pre-configured during setup
- Manage permissions via Settings → Cowork, or via OS privacy settings
- Create your workspace folder structure before starting file-based tasks
- Grant only what Cowork needs — you can expand access as tasks require it

Your Turn

Create a dedicated workspace folder for your own work or business — not the Pashun Sports example. Give it a clear name. Add subfolders for the types of work you'll do. Run the README task above adapted to your folder.

End of Lesson: How To Grant Folder Access So Claude Can Read, Edit, And Create Files

How To Use Projects To Organise Your Work And Build Persistent Workspaces

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Without Projects, every Cowork session starts fresh. Claude has no memory of what you worked on yesterday, what your preferences are, or what files it's already seen. Projects fix this — they give Claude a permanent workspace for a specific job, with memory, instructions, and scheduled tasks that persist across every session.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Projects	Group related tasks into a persistent workspace with memory, instructions, and scheduled tasks	Starting from scratch every session, re-explaining context, losing continuity across recurring work

Projects vs a Standalone Folder Session

Selecting a folder in Cowork gives Claude file access. Creating a Project around that folder gives Claude everything else.

	Standalone folder session	Project
File access	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Memory across sessions	✗ No — starts fresh every time	✓ Yes — persists automatically
Custom instructions	✗ No	✓ Yes — set once, applied every session
Scheduled tasks	Global only	✓ Scoped to the project
Context carries forward	✗ No	✓ Claude builds on previous work

What's Included in a Project

- Instructions — Add tone, formatting rules, or background context. Claude applies them on every task in this project without being told again.

- **Memory** — Claude remembers what it worked on and what decisions were made. Scoped to this project only — doesn't carry over to other projects.
- **Context** — Attach a local folder, link a Claude chat project, or paste in a URL. Claude references all of it on every task.
- **Scheduled Tasks** — Recurring tasks inside the project run with full project context and memory.

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop → Cowork tab → click Projects in the left sidebar.
2. Click the + button. You'll see three creation options.
3. Start from scratch — create a new folder, add instructions and files. Best for a brand new workflow.
4. Import from a Claude project — transfers files and instructions from an existing claude.ai project. Best if you've already built context in Chat.
5. Use an existing folder — point to a folder already on your computer. Add instructions and extra files. Best for workflows already in progress — like your PashunSports/ folder.
6. Name the project, choose where to save it, add instructions, and click Create.
7. The project appears in your sidebar. Every task you run inside it gets the full context automatically.

Demo — Creating the Pashun Sports Project

Step 1 — Create

Projects → + → Use an existing folder → select your PashunSports/ folder → name it 'Pashun Sports World Cup 2026' → click Create.

Step 2 — Add Instructions

We are Pashun Sports, a fan-first organic cotton T-shirt brand launching into the World Cup 2026 market across UK, Brazil, and Argentina.

All outputs should be direct and business-ready.

Germany and Spain are out of scope — never include them.

Argentina tee colourway is sky blue and white STRIPES — not plain blue.

Always show me your plan before making changes to files.

Step 3 — Run the First Task

```
Read everything in this folder.  
  
Summarise what you know about this workspace: what's here,  
what I use it for, and what instructions you'll follow.  
  
If anything is unclear, ask before proceeding.
```

This onboarding task lets Claude build initial context on day one. Every subsequent task in the project benefits from that context automatically.

Memory in Projects

Memory is enabled automatically for Cowork projects.

Claude remembers context from tasks you've run in a project and applies it to future tasks in the same project.

Memory is scoped to the project — what Claude learns in your Pashun Sports project stays there. It doesn't carry over to other projects or standalone sessions.

This is why the same task brief produces better results inside a project over time. Claude isn't starting fresh — it's building on what it already knows about your work.

Current Limitations

Note

Desktop only, stored locally. Projects live on your computer. There is no cloud sync — you can't access a project from a different machine.

Cowork only. Projects are not available in Claude Code yet — support is planned for a future update.

Archiving doesn't delete files. When you archive a project, the metadata is removed from the UI but your local files and folders are untouched.

Requires the latest Claude Desktop. Update before trying to access Projects if you haven't recently.



Summary

- Projects give Claude a persistent workspace — memory, instructions, context, and scheduled tasks that carry across every session
- Three creation methods: Start from scratch · Import from Claude chat project · Use an existing folder
- Memory is scoped to the project — Claude learns your work without leaking into other projects
- Instructions set once are applied automatically on every task — no re-explaining
- Desktop only, stored locally — no cloud sync at this time



Your Turn

Go to Projects → + → Use an existing folder. Select your PashunSports/ folder (or your own work folder). Add a short instructions block — your business context, tone preference, and anything Claude should always know. Run the first task: 'Read everything in this folder. Summarise what you know and ask if anything is unclear.' From now on, run all your tasks inside this project.



End of Lesson: How To Use Projects To Organise Your Work And Build Persistent Workspaces

How To Set Permissions And Stay In Control Of What Claude Can Touch



Intro — What We're Doing Today

Cowork is designed to keep you in control. Before it takes any significant action — renaming files, creating folders, modifying documents — it shows you a plan and waits for your approval. This lesson shows you how to use the approval flow and how to steer Cowork when it needs adjusting.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Task Approval & Oversight	Review and approve Cowork's plan before it executes	Cowork making changes you didn't intend, or feeling like you've lost visibility



Demo — The Approval Flow in Action

The Scenario

It's week one at Pashun Sports. You have a rough notes file — the founding team's goals, product ideas, target markets, and brand values scribbled down after a planning session. You want to turn it into something the whole team can see and react to.

Step 1 — Assign a Task

```
Read my /PashunSports/PashunSports_Notes.txt file and produce  
a visual HTML brand vision board.
```

```
The board should include:
```

- A mission statement card (extract from notes)
- A target customer card (who we're making tees for)
- Three product pillars (what makes our tees different)
- World Cup opportunity summary (key dates, territories)
- First visual concept of our hero tees — show each in its proposed
colourway with a short design direction note:
England tee: white/navy/red | Brazil tee: yellow/green
Argentina tee: sky blue/white

```
Save as: /PashunSports/BrandVisionBoard.html
```

```
Show me your plan before creating the file.
```

Step 2 — Review the Plan

Cowork responds with a numbered list of steps it intends to take. Read it before approving.

Example plan Cowork might show:

1. Read /PashunSports/PashunSports_Notes.txt
2. Extract: mission, target customer, product pillars, World Cup notes
3. Create SVG flat-lay concepts for England, Brazil, Argentina tees
4. Build HTML vision board with card layout — mission, customer,
pillars, World Cup summary, tee concept visuals
5. Save to /PashunSports/BrandVisionBoard.html

Shall I proceed?

Step 3 — Approve, Redirect, or Refine

```
Looks right. Add one more card: our key brand values (extract
from the notes). Then proceed.
```

Step 4 — Intervene Mid-Task

If Cowork is running and you spot a problem, type your instruction at any time:

```
Stop. The tee colours look wrong — Argentina should be sky blue
and white stripes, not plain blue. Fix that before continuing.
```

 Cowork will always pause before any irreversible action such as deleting files. For edits, it keeps a record of what was changed so you can review it.

The BrandVisionBoard.html output opens directly in any browser — the whole team can see it immediately.

Summary

- Always include 'show me the plan first' in new or complex task briefs
- Cowork waits for approval before significant actions — this is by design
- You can redirect, refine, or stop at any point during a task
- Typing 'Stop' immediately halts execution

Your Turn

Run a task on a non-critical folder from your own work. Practice the approval flow: read the plan, change one thing about it before approving. Get comfortable steering before using Cowork on important files.

End of Lesson: How To Set Permissions And Stay In Control Of What Claude Can Touch

How To Assign A Task And Let Cowork Handle The Steps

Intro — What We're Doing Today

This is the core Cowork skill: giving Claude a multi-step goal and letting it plan and execute each step without you managing them one by one. We're running Pashun Sports' first real planning task.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Multi-Step Task Execution	Cowork plans and runs a sequence of steps to reach a defined outcome	Manually doing multi-step work step by step when Cowork can handle the whole sequence

Demo — World Cup Launch Gantt Chart

The Scenario

The Pashun Sports team has agreed the World Cup 2026 strategy. Now you need a visual project plan the whole team can follow — from design through to tournament week. You have a brief text file outlining the phases and key dates.

Step 1 — Write the Task Brief

Read my /PashunSports/WorldCupLaunchBrief.txt file and produce a colour-coded HTML Gantt chart for the World Cup 2026 launch.

The chart should cover January to July 2026 and include:

- Phase 1 (Jan-Feb): Design & product sign-off
- Phase 2 (Feb-Mar): Production & supplier orders
- Phase 3 (Mar-Apr): Marketing build & content creation
- Phase 4 (Apr-May): Pre-launch & retailer sell-in
- Phase 5 (Jun-Jul): Tournament window & live sales

Mark these milestone dates:

- 15 Feb: All designs approved
- 30 Mar: All stock with KitPro
- 15 May: Marketing campaign live
- 11 Jun: World Cup 2026 kicks off

Use a different colour for each phase.

Highlight England, Brazil, and Argentina launch dates.

Save as: /PashunSports/Reports/WorldCupGantt.html

Show me your plan first.

Step 2 — Approve and Walk Away

Once you approve the plan, Cowork executes each step in sequence. The finished Gantt chart opens in any browser — the whole team can see the project at a glance.

Step 3 — Review and Refine

The Phase 3 bar looks too short — marketing should run through to the end of May, not just April. Please update and re-save.



Summary

- Write the task as a numbered list with a clear output file defined
- Include the folder path and output file name explicitly
- Approve the plan — then let Cowork run without managing each step
- Review and refine in one follow-up message if needed



Your Turn

Pick a real multi-step task from your own work — something that normally takes 20–30 minutes. Write it as a Cowork brief with numbered steps and a defined output. Run it with your own files.



End of Lesson: How To Assign A Task And Let Cowork Handle The Steps

How To Review Claude's Plan Before It Acts

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Cowork shows you its plan before acting. A 30-second plan review prevents 30 minutes of cleanup. This lesson teaches you what to look for and how to improve a plan before approving.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Plan Review	Read, adjust, and approve Cowork's execution plan before it runs	Approving plans without reading them and needing to undo or redo work

Demo — Campaign Milestone Tracker

The Scenario

The World Cup launch is running across six workstreams. You need a status dashboard the team can update and check every Monday morning — something that shows at a glance who owns what, what's due, and what's on fire.

The Task

Read /PashunSports/WorldCupLaunchBrief.txt and produce an HTML campaign milestone tracker.

Include these workstreams:

Design | Print & Production | Fulfilment | Marketing | PR | Social

For each workstream show:

- Owner name
- Current milestone and due date
- Status: Red (overdue), Amber (at risk), Green (on track)

The tracker should be colour-coded by status.

Save as: /PashunSports/Reports/MilestoneTracker.html

Show me the plan first.

What Cowork's Plan Might Look Like

Plan:

1. Read /PashunSports/WorldCupLaunchBrief.txt
2. Extract workstreams, owners, milestones, and due dates
3. Assign default status: Green (placeholder — to be updated by team)
4. Build HTML table with colour-coded status dots per workstream
5. Save to /PashunSports/Reports/MilestoneTracker.html

Shall I proceed?

What To Check

- Are all six workstreams accounted for in the plan?
- Is the status logic right — will Red visually stand out from Green?
- Is the output path exactly where you want it?
- Are there steps missing that you need?

Improving the Plan Before Approving

Good, but also add a 'Last updated' timestamp at the top of the page. And make the Red status rows bold as well as red – not just a coloured dot. Then proceed.



Summary

- Read the full plan before approving — it takes 30 seconds
- Check all workstreams are covered, output paths correct, and logic as expected
- Add missing steps or change the approach before approving
- A better plan = a better output with no rework



Your Turn

Run a Cowork task on your own files and instead of approving immediately, read the plan line by line. Find one thing to improve before you approve. Notice how it changes the output.



End of Lesson: How To Review Claude's Plan Before It Acts

How To Watch Tasks In Real Time And Step In When Needed



Intro — What We're Doing Today

Cowork runs tasks autonomously, but you're always in the loop. You can watch it work in real time and redirect or stop it at any moment. This lesson shows you how to read Cowork's progress and intervene confidently.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Real-Time Task Monitoring	Watch Cowork's step-by-step progress and intervene mid-task	Feeling like you've lost control during a long task, or not knowing when to step in



Demo — Territory Opportunity Brief

The Scenario

Pashun Sports is launching in three territories: UK, Brazil, and Argentina. You need a ranked opportunity brief for each — market size, World Cup interest, Pashun's current reach, and a recommended launch priority. Cowork reads your project notes and market data files to build it.

The Task

Read the following files:

`/PashunSports/WorldCupLaunchBrief.txt`

`/PashunSports/PashunSports_Notes.txt`

Produce a territory opportunity brief covering:

- UK, Brazil, and Argentina
- For each: market context, World Cup relevance, Pashun's position
- Ranked recommendation: which to prioritise and why

Tone: direct, data-informed, one page per territory.

Save as: `/PashunSports/Reports/TerritoryOpportunity_2026.docx`

Show me your plan first.

Intervening When Cowork Goes Off-Brief

Halfway through, you notice Cowork has started writing recommendations for Germany and Spain — markets not in scope. Intervene immediately:

Stop. We only need UK, Brazil, and Argentina – remove the Germany and Spain sections entirely. Resume from the Argentina section.

When to Intervene

- The output file or path looks wrong before it writes
- Cowork is interpreting your brief more broadly than intended
- A step is working on content you didn't include in scope
- You realise the brief was incomplete and need to adjust mid-run



Cowork will always pause before any irreversible action such as deleting files. For edits, it keeps a record of what was changed so you can review it.



Summary

- Cowork shows live progress — you can watch or come back to the result
- Type your instruction at any point to redirect, refine, or stop
- Cowork pauses before any irreversible action
- Typing 'Stop' halts execution immediately



Your Turn

Run a multi-file task on your own files and stay in the Cowork panel while it runs. Practice typing a mid-task redirect — even if the task is going fine. Get comfortable with the intervention flow before you need it on something important.



End of Lesson: How To Watch Tasks In Real Time And Step In When Needed

How To Organise Messy Folders Using Cowork

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Folder chaos slows every business down — files named 'final_v3_USE_THIS.csv', spec sheets mixed with random screenshots, design notes sitting in Downloads. Cowork reads your folder, proposes a structure, reorganises everything after you review and approve, then uses the clean files to produce a finished output.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Folder Organisation	Cowork reads, proposes, renames, and restructures your files	Spending hours manually sorting files that Cowork can handle in minutes

Demo — Organising the Pashun Sports Product Downloads

The Scenario

Your Downloads folder is chaos — spec sheets with inconsistent names, design notes, pricing files, product images, screenshots, and old drafts all mixed together. Cowork cleans it up, then immediately uses the newly organised files to produce the product range lookbook.

Step 1 — Organise the folder

```
Help me organise my /PashunSports/Downloads/ folder.
```

```
Scan the contents and propose a plan:
```

- What categories/folders should I create?
- How should files be sorted into them?
- What naming convention should I apply?
- Any files to flag for review or deletion?

```
Show me the plan and wait for my approval before making any changes.
```

What Cowork Might Propose

Found 25 files. Proposed structure:

/Products/WorldCup2026/ → 8 spec sheets (rename: ProductName_Specs.txt)

/Products/WorldCup2026/ → 1 pricing CSV (keep name)

/Products/WorldCup2026/ → 1 design notes file

/Marketing/ → 4 campaign brief drafts

/Suppliers/ → 3 supplier pricing files

/Review/ → 8 unclear files — flagged for your decision

Shall I proceed?

Review, adjust if needed, approve. Cowork reorganises everything.

Step 2 — Use the clean files immediately

Once organised, follow up in the same task:

```
Now read all files in /PashunSports/Products/WorldCup2026/
```

```
and produce an HTML product range lookbook:
```

- Show each tee as an SVG flat-lay in its correct colourway
- Include SKU, RRP, target territory, and launch status
- Group by territory: UK, Brazil, Argentina

```
Save as: /PashunSports/Marketing/PashunSports_Lookbook.html
```



The lookbook HTML opens in any browser — the product range is now visible to the whole team for the first time.

Files it can't categorise are flagged for your review — Cowork does not delete without permission.

✓ Summary

- Describe the folder, ask for a proposal, and review before approving
- Cowork handles renaming, restructuring, and creating subfolders
- Files it can't categorise are flagged for your review — it does not delete without permission
- Chain tasks: organise the folder, then immediately use the clean files to produce the next output

🎯 Your Turn

Pick the messiest folder in your own work or business. Ask Cowork to scan it and propose an organisation plan. Review it before approving. Run it on files you can afford to reorganise.

✓ End of Lesson: How To Organise Messy Folders Using Cowork

How To Turn Raw Data And Screenshots Into Finished Spreadsheets



Intro — What We're Doing Today

A lot of business data arrives in messy forms — order exports with columns you don't need, screenshots of pricing tables, supplier spreadsheets in different formats. Cowork reads all of these and produces a clean, consistent spreadsheet you can actually use.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Data Extraction & Spreadsheet Creation	Read multiple source files and produce a clean output spreadsheet	Manually copying data between files, reformatting CSVs, merging spreadsheets by hand



Demo — Pashun Sports Weekly Sales Spreadsheet

The Scenario

You have three order CSV exports from this week — each with many columns you don't need. You need a clean weekly sales spreadsheet with only the columns that matter.

```
Read the three CSV files in /PashunSports/Orders/Week18/:
```

- orders_mon_tue.csv
- orders_wed_thu.csv
- orders_fri_sat.csv

```
Create a single spreadsheet: /PashunSports/Reports/WeeklySales_Wk18.xlsx
```

```
Include only these columns:
```

```
Order ID | Date | Product Name | Qty | Price | Status | Customer Email
```

```
Add a summary row at the bottom:
```

```
Total orders | Total revenue | Average order value
```

```
Highlight any orders with Status = 'Cancelled' in red.
```

```
Show plan first.
```

From a Screenshot or Image

If your data arrives as a screenshot (e.g., from a supplier's web portal), Cowork can read the image and extract it into a spreadsheet. Upload the image to your Cowork task folder first, then:

```
There is a screenshot called 'FabricFirst_pricing.png' in
```

```
/ PashunSports/Suppliers/.
```

```
Extract the pricing table from this image and save it as a  
properly formatted spreadsheet:
```

```
/ PashunSports/Suppliers/FabricFirst_Pricing_Apr2026.xlsx
```

Including File Uploads in a Task

You can also upload files directly to the Cowork task input — drag and drop or use the + button in the Cowork interface. Cowork reads the uploaded file and uses it as part of the task.

I've uploaded a PDF invoice from our supplier PrintForce.

Extract the following from it:

- Invoice number
- Line items with quantities and prices
- Total amount and payment due date

Save the extracted data as:

/ PashunSports/Suppliers/PrintForce_Invoice_Extract_Apr2026.xlsx



Summary

- Cowork reads CSVs, Excel files, images of tables, and uploaded PDFs in a single task
- Specify exactly which columns you want — Cowork strips the rest
- Define output file name and path explicitly
- Summary rows, conditional formatting, and highlighting are all supported
- Use the + button in Cowork to upload files directly to the task



Your Turn

Take a CSV or spreadsheet from your own work that has more columns than you need. Ask Cowork to extract only the columns you care about and produce a clean output file.



End of Lesson: How To Turn Raw Data And Screenshots Into Finished Spreadsheets

How To Generate Reports And Documents From Your Files



Intro — What We're Doing Today

One of the most powerful Cowork capabilities is turning scattered files into finished, readable documents and dashboards. Data files become briefings. Invoice files become a colour-coded status board. This lesson shows you how to go from raw inputs to polished output without any manual writing.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Document Generation From Files	Read source files and produce structured finished documents and dashboards	Spending an hour writing a report that Cowork can draft in minutes from your own files



Demo — Pashun Sports Supplier Status Dashboard

The Scenario

It's mid-April. Production is underway across three suppliers. You need a live view of where every supplier stands — outstanding invoices, upcoming due dates, lead time status — without opening a single spreadsheet.

```
Read all files in /PashunSports/Suppliers/:  
  
- Invoice files (KitPro, PrintForce, FabricFirst)  
  
- Pricing agreements  
  
- Delivery notes  
  
Produce an HTML supplier status dashboard.  
  
For each supplier show:  
  
- A status card with their name and current status colour  
  (Red = overdue payment | Amber = due within 7 days | Green = clear)  
  
- Outstanding invoice total  
  
- Most recent delivery note summary  
  
- Lead time and next expected delivery  
  
Save as: /PashunSports/Reports/SupplierDashboard.html  
  
(Opens in any browser — share with the operations team)  
  
Show plan first.
```



The supplier dashboard opens in any browser and shows the operations team at a glance where every supplier relationship stands.

Red/amber/green status coding means the team can spot a problem in seconds — no spreadsheet required.



Demo 2 — Monthly Performance Report

The Scenario

It's end of month. You have a sales CSV, a customer feedback file, a supplier invoice summary, and your own notes. You need a written monthly report.

Using the following files in /PashunSports/Reports/April/:

- april_sales.csv
- customer_feedback_april.txt
- supplier_invoices_summary.xlsx
- my_notes_april.txt

Write a monthly performance report for Pashun Sports.

Structure:

1. Sales Overview (from CSV)
2. Top Products (from CSV — focus on World Cup range)
3. Customer Feedback Summary (from feedback file)
4. Supplier Costs (from invoice summary)
5. Key Observations (from my notes)
6. One Recommended Action for May

Tone: clear, direct, business-appropriate. Max 600 words.

Save as: /PashunSports/Reports/April/PashunSports_April_Report.docx

Show plan first.



Summary

- Give Cowork multiple source files and it reads and synthesises across all of them
- Define the output format — HTML dashboard or Word document — and Cowork produces it
- Set a word count and tone to keep written outputs usable
- Cowork saves directly to your specified path — no copy-pasting needed



Your Turn

Identify a report you write manually every month in your own business or role. Collect the source files it draws from. Ask Cowork to draft it from those files. Compare the time taken.



End of Lesson: How To Generate Reports And Documents From Your Files

How To Extract Structured Data From Contracts, Records, And Dense Files



Intro — What We're Doing Today

The most valuable data in any business is often buried inside PDFs — supplier contracts, purchase orders, terms documents. Manually reading through them to find key terms is slow and error-prone. Cowork reads these documents, extracts specific data points, and puts them in a format you can use.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Document Data Extraction	Read PDFs and dense files and extract structured data to a usable format	Reading through contracts manually to find payment terms, lead times, or renewal dates



Demo — Extracting Pashun Sports Supplier Contract Terms

The Scenario

Pashun Sports has contracts with four suppliers. You need to know: minimum order quantities, payment terms, lead times, and renewal dates — all in one place.


```
Read all PDF files in /PashunSports/Suppliers/Contracts/
```

```
For each contract, extract:
```

- Supplier name
- Minimum order quantity (MOQ)
- Payment terms (e.g. Net 30, Net 60)
- Lead time
- Contract renewal date

```
Compile into a single spreadsheet:
```

```
/PashunSports/Suppliers/SupplierTerms_Summary.xlsx
```

```
If any field is missing from a contract, mark as 'Not specified'.
```

```
Show plan first.
```

What You Get

A clean spreadsheet with one row per supplier and all extracted terms — something that would take 2–3 hours to build manually from multiple PDFs.



Cowork reads PDFs directly from your folder — no uploading required.

It handles multi-page documents, tables within PDFs, and scanned files with readable text.

You can also upload PDFs directly to a Cowork task using the + button for one-off extractions.



Summary

- Specify exactly which data points to extract — Cowork won't guess
- Works on PDFs, Word docs, text files, and spreadsheets simultaneously
- Missing fields are flagged rather than left blank — no silent gaps
- Output goes directly to your specified file path

Your Turn

Find a set of PDFs or dense documents in your own work that contain information you have to look up manually. Ask Cowork to extract the key fields into a spreadsheet.

End of Lesson: How To Extract Structured Data From Contracts, Records, And Dense Files

How To Schedule Tasks So Claude Runs Work On A Set Cadence

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Scheduled tasks are one of Cowork's most powerful features. You define a task once, set a cadence — daily, weekly, every Monday at 8am — and Cowork runs it automatically. This lesson shows you how to set up your first scheduled task for Pashun Sports.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Scheduled Tasks	Define a task once and Cowork runs it automatically on a set cadence	Remembering to run the same report every week, doing the same data pull every morning

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop → Cowork tab.
2. In the left sidebar, click 'Scheduled'.
3. Click '+ New task' and write your task brief.
4. Set the cadence: hourly, daily, weekly, or weekdays only.
5. Click 'More options' to select the model and set the Cowork folder.
6. Save. Cowork will run the task on schedule.
7. To pause or edit: Scheduled → click on the task → Pause, Edit, or Delete.
8. You can also type /schedule in any Cowork task to trigger the scheduled task setup.
9. Missed runs auto-execute when the computer wakes up or the app reopens.

Demo — Pashun Sports Daily Production Briefing

The Scenario

During the production phase, every morning at 8am you want a status briefing: how many units are in production, how many are ready to ship, and whether anything needs attention before the day starts.

SCHEDULED TASK — runs daily at 08:00

Read the latest files in /PashunSports/Orders/Daily/ and
/ PashunSports/Suppliers/

Produce a morning production briefing saved to

/ PashunSports/Reports/Daily/

File name: ProductionBrief_YYYY-MM-DD.txt

Include:

- Units ordered but not yet in production
- Units in production per supplier
- Units ready to ship
- Any supplier issues flagged in latest emails or notes
- Any orders at risk of missing delivery deadline

Keep it under 200 words. Factual. No padding.

How to Set This Up

Scheduled → New task → paste the brief → set cadence to Daily → set time to 08:00 → click More options → select model → set your Cowork folder → Save.

⚠ Scheduled tasks only run while your computer is awake and the Claude Desktop app is open.

Missed runs execute automatically when the app reopens or computer wakes.

✅ Summary

- Scheduled → New task → write brief → set cadence → Save
- Cadences: hourly, daily, weekly, weekdays only
- Type /schedule in any task to trigger the setup flow
- Missed runs execute automatically when the app reopens
- Your computer must be awake and Claude Desktop open for scheduled tasks to run

Your Turn

Identify one task you trigger manually every day or week in your own work. Set it up as a Scheduled Task in Cowork. Set the cadence, save it, and let it run on its own.

End of Lesson: How To Schedule Tasks So Claude Runs Work On A Set Cadence

How To Set Up Recurring Workflows And Walk Away

Intro — What We're Doing Today

A scheduled task runs one thing on a cadence. A recurring workflow chains multiple steps into a single scheduled task — so Cowork runs an entire sequence of work automatically. This lesson shows how to build a complete recurring marketing workflow for Pashun Sports.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Recurring Multi-Step Workflows	Chain multiple task steps into a single recurring workflow	Running each part of a weekly routine separately, one trigger at a time

Demo — Pashun Sports Weekly Marketing Pack

The Scenario

Every Friday at 5pm, Cowork should automatically identify the week's best-selling tee, produce a customer-facing HTML email newsletter for it, and create a product launch page — ready for the marketing team to review on Monday morning.

RECURRING WORKFLOW — runs every Friday at 17:00

Step 1: Read /PashunSports/Reports/Weekly/ — find this week's
top product by units sold (from the weekly sales CSV)

Step 2: Read the spec file for that product from
/PashunSports/Products/WorldCup2026/

Step 3: Produce a customer-facing HTML email newsletter:

- SVG flat-lay of the tee as the hero visual
- Bold headline: [Product Name] — World Cup 2026
- 2 lines of fan-first body copy
- CTA button: 'Shop Now at PashunSports.co.uk'
- Footer with social links

Save as: /PashunSports/Marketing/LaunchEmail_YYYY-WW.html

Step 4: Produce a product launch HTML page:

- Full product view with tee SVG
- Name, price, sizes, description, 'Add to Bag' button

Save as: /PashunSports/Marketing/ProductPage_YYYY-WW.html

If any step fails, log the error and continue with remaining steps.

Do not ask for approval — run all steps automatically.

Key Principle: 'Do Not Ask For Approval'

For recurring workflows you trust, include this in your brief. It tells Cowork to run all steps without pausing for confirmation. Only use this after testing the workflow manually at least once.

⚠️ Test any recurring workflow manually at least once — with 'show me the plan first' — before scheduling it without approval prompts.

The HTML email and product page are drafts for review — the team publishes them, Cowork doesn't send or publish automatically.



Summary

- Chain multiple steps into a single recurring workflow brief
- Schedule via Scheduled → New task → set cadence → Save
- Include 'do not ask for approval' only after you've tested the workflow manually
- Add error handling: 'if any step fails, log and continue'



Your Turn

Take a weekly routine from your own work. Test it manually in Cowork once with 'show me the plan first'. Then set it up as a recurring scheduled workflow.



End of Lesson: How To Set Up Recurring Workflows And Walk Away

How To Use Claude In Chrome To Browse And Research On Your Behalf

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Claude in Chrome brings Claude directly into your browser. It can read the page you're on, extract data, and save findings to your local files — all without switching windows. For Pashun Sports, this means researching competitors, extracting supplier pricing, and gathering market data automatically.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Claude in Chrome	Use Claude inside any website — read pages, extract data, save to local files	Context-switching between browser and Claude, manually copying web content into files



Where To Find This in Cowork

1. In Claude Desktop, click your initials (bottom-left) → Settings → Connectors.
2. Find 'Claude in Chrome' and toggle it on.
3. Click 'Download extension' — this takes you to the Chrome Web Store.
4. Click 'Add to Chrome' to install the official Anthropic extension.
5. Pin it: click the puzzle piece icon in Chrome toolbar → click the pin next to Claude.
6. Click the Claude icon in your Chrome toolbar on any webpage to open the side panel.
7. Sign in with your Claude account when prompted.
8. Note: Claude in Chrome works with Google Chrome only — not other Chromium browsers.
9. Pro plan: limited to Haiku 4.5. Max, Team, Enterprise: choose your model.



Demo — Three Pashun Sports Chrome Workflows

Workflow 1 — Competitor Research

You're browsing a competitor sports merchandise site. Open Claude in Chrome:

```
Summarise the top 5 products on this page.  
Note their prices, any World Cup or tournament messaging,  
and how they describe their brand.  
Save the summary to /PashunSports/Marketing/CompetitorResearch_Apr2026.txt
```

Workflow 2 — Supplier Price Extraction

You're logged into a supplier's portal showing pricing. Claude in Chrome:

```
Extract the pricing table on this page.  
Format it as a CSV with columns: Product, MOQ, Price Per Unit, Lead Time.  
Save to /PashunSports/Suppliers/FabricFirst_Prices_Apr2026.csv
```

Workflow 3 — Cowork + Chrome Combined

From a Cowork task, instruct Claude to use Chrome for a research step:

```
Step 1: Use Chrome to visit google.com/trends and search for  
'world cup 2026 merchandise' - note the top related topics  
and any rising searches.  
  
Step 2: Read /PashunSports/Products/CurrentRange_2026.xlsx  
  
Step 3: Compare trending terms to our product range.  
- Which trends match products we already carry?  
- Which are gaps we could target before the tournament?  
  
Step 4: Save a brief analysis to:  
  
/PashunSports/Marketing/TrendAnalysis_Apr2026.docx
```



Summary

- Enable in Settings → Connectors → Claude in Chrome → toggle on → install extension
- Pin the extension to your Chrome toolbar for easy access
- Claude in Chrome reads pages, extracts data, and saves to your Cowork folders
- Works with Google Chrome only — not Brave, Arc, or other Chromium browsers
- Combine with Cowork tasks for web research + local file work in one workflow



Your Turn

Install Claude in Chrome if you haven't already. Open a website relevant to your own work. Trigger Claude in Chrome and ask it to summarise or extract something from the page. Save it to a folder on your machine.



End of Lesson: How To Use Claude In Chrome To Browse And Research On Your Behalf

How To Combine Web Research With Local File Work In A Single Task



Intro — What We're Doing Today

The real power of Cowork's web integration is combining it with local files in a single task. Browse a website, pull the data, merge it with what's in your folder, and produce a finished output — one brief, one execution, one result.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Web + Local File Combination	Pull web data and local file data together in a single workflow	Running research and analysis as two separate manual steps, then combining by hand



Demo — Pashun Sports Trend vs Inventory Analysis

The Scenario

You want to know: which football shirt styles are trending before the 2026 World Cup, and do we have those designs in our current range? Cowork answers this by researching the web and comparing against your local files.

Research + inventory task for Pashun Sports:

Step 1: Use Chrome to visit the following pages and note any

trending football merchandise, shirt styles, or fan gear:

- football-fashion.com (real site: football kit trends)
- soccerbible.com (real site: kit design news)

Extract: trending styles, colours, player names on shirts

Step 2: Read /PashunSports/Products/CurrentRange_2026.xlsx

Step 3: Compare trending styles to our current range.

- Which are already in our catalogue?
- Which are trending but not in our range (gaps)?

Step 4: Produce a colour-coded HTML gap analysis report:

- Green rows: trends we already cover
- Red rows: trending styles we're missing

Save as: /PashunSports/Marketing/WorldCupTrendGap_Apr2026.html

Show plan first.

Cowork uses Chrome for the web research steps and your local files for the comparison — automatically, in sequence. The output is a visual HTML gap report the product team can act on immediately.



Summary

- Include web steps and local file steps in the same task brief
- Cowork picks the right tool for each step — Chrome for web, file access for local
- The output is one document drawing from both sources
- Use real websites (soccerbible.com, google.com/trends) — Cowork can navigate them

Your Turn

Design a task for your own business that combines something from a real website with a local file. Write the brief with numbered steps for each. Run it and review the combined output.

End of Lesson: How To Combine Web Research With Local File Work In A Single Task

How To Use Connectors To Link Cowork To External Services

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Connectors link Cowork directly to the tools you already use — Gmail, Google Drive, Google Calendar, Slack, Notion, Microsoft 365, and 38+ others. Once connected, Cowork can search, read, and act across them from a single task brief without you switching apps.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Connectors	Link Cowork to external services so it can read and act across your apps	Manually copying information between Claude and your tools, doing research across separate apps

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop → click your initials (bottom-left) → Settings → Connectors.
2. Browse the available connectors. Click 'Connect' next to the app you want.
3. Follow the sign-in flow to authorise Cowork's access.
4. Once connected, reference the connector in any Cowork task: 'Check my Gmail for...' or 'Read my Calendar for...'
5. You can also access the Connectors view from the Cowork sidebar → Customize.
6. Manage or disconnect at any time from Settings → Connectors.
7. Important: For Gmail write actions (sending email), the default setting is 'Needs Approval' — Cowork will show you the draft before sending. You can change this to 'Always Allow' in the connector permissions if you trust the workflow.

Demo — Three Pashun Sports Connector Workflows

Workflow 1 — Google Calendar → Match-Day Social Posts

Cowork reads the World Cup match dates already in your Google Calendar, pairs each England/Brazil/Argentina fixture with the right product, and drafts a match-day social post timed for 2 hours before kick-off.

```
Read my Google Calendar for all World Cup 2026 match events  
involving England, Brazil, or Argentina.
```

```
For each match:
```

- Identify the relevant Pashun Sports tee (from /PashunSports/Products/)
- Draft a match-day social post for Instagram and X
- Time it for 2 hours before kick-off
- Include the correct hashtags for the territory

```
Save all posts to:
```

```
/ PashunSports/Marketing/MatchDaySocialPosts.txt
```

Workflow 2 — Gmail → Send a Customer Feedback Digest

Cowork searches Gmail for customer emails, summarises the themes, and sends a weekly digest to the Pashun Sports team email address.

```
Check my Gmail for any customer emails received in the last 7 days.
```

```
Look for: complaints, refund requests, sizing questions,  
shipping problems, positive feedback about World Cup tees.
```

```
Summarise the key themes into a weekly digest.
```

```
Send the digest as an email to team@pashunSports.co.uk with  
subject: 'Customer Feedback Digest - w/e [date]'
```

```
Wait for my approval before sending.
```




Gmail connector: by default, Cowork creates a draft and shows it to you before sending. This is the 'Needs Approval' setting — the right default for any outbound email.

You can change individual connector permissions in Settings → Connectors → Gmail → Tool permissions.

Workflow 3 — Google Drive → Local Report

```
Read the file 'PashunSports_Inventory_2026.xlsx' from my Google Drive
in the folder 'Pashun Sports'.

Identify any products where stock is below 20 units.

Save a restock alert as /PashunSports/Reports/RestockAlert_Apr2026.txt
```



Summary

- Settings → Connectors → Connect — authorise once and use in any task
- Available: Gmail, Google Drive, Google Calendar, Slack, Notion, Microsoft 365, and 38+ more
- Gmail can send email — default is 'Needs Approval' so you review before anything goes out
- Connectors work inside scheduled tasks too — automate the pull



Your Turn

Connect Claude to one app you use every day — Gmail or Google Calendar are good starting points. Ask Cowork to read something from that tool and produce a useful output from it.



End of Lesson: How To Use Connectors To Link Cowork To External Services

How To Connect Microsoft 365 — Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneDrive And SharePoint



Intro — What We're Doing Today

Microsoft 365 connects to Cowork through a single connector — Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneDrive, and SharePoint all in one. For Pashun Sports, this means reading and writing Office files both locally and in the cloud from a single task.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Microsoft 365 Connector	Access the full Office suite and OneDrive/SharePoint from one Cowork connector	Manually downloading files from OneDrive, opening Excel to run reports, or editing Word docs by hand



Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Settings → Connectors → find Microsoft 365 → click Connect.
2. Sign in with your Microsoft account and authorise access.
3. The single connector covers: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneDrive, and SharePoint.
4. Use in any Cowork task: 'Read my OneDrive Pashun Sports folder', 'Update the Excel file on SharePoint'.
5. Claude also has a native add-in for Excel and PowerPoint — find it at claude.ai/download under 'Extensions'.



Demo — Pashun Sports Microsoft 365 Workflows

Workflow 1 — Read OneDrive → Local Report

```
Read the file 'PashunSports_StockLevels.xlsx' from my OneDrive
in the 'Pashun Sports' folder.

Identify any products where stock is below 15 units.

Save a restock alert as /PashunSports/Reports/RestockAlert_Apr2026.txt
```

Workflow 2 — Local Data → Update OneDrive

```
Read /PashunSports/Reports/WeeklySales_Wk18.xlsx
Update the 'Sales Tracker' Excel file on my OneDrive
in the 'Pashun Sports Operations' folder.

Add this week's data as a new row in the existing table.
```

Workflow 3 — Generate a Word Brief → Save to OneDrive

```
Using /PashunSports/Reports/April/PashunSports_April_Report.docx
as source, create a formatted supplier brief covering our top 3
suppliers, their Q1 performance, and upcoming World Cup orders.
Save to OneDrive in 'Pashun Sports/Supplier Briefs/April 2026/'.
```



Summary

- One connector covers all of Microsoft 365 — Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneDrive, SharePoint
- Connect via Settings → Connectors → Microsoft 365
- Works with both local files and cloud files in the same task
- The Excel and PowerPoint add-in for Claude is separate — find it at claude.ai/download



Your Turn

If your team uses Microsoft 365, connect the connector. Run a simple task: ask Cowork to read a file from OneDrive and summarise its contents.



End of Lesson: How To Connect Microsoft 365 — Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneDrive And SharePoint

How To Build Multi-App Workflows Using Connectors And Files Together



Intro — What We're Doing Today

Individual connectors are powerful on their own. Combined with local files and other connectors, they become an automated cross-tool pipeline. This lesson shows how to build a Pashun Sports workflow that combines Gmail, local files, Google Drive, and produces a visual HTML dashboard — all in one task.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Multi-App + File Workflows	Chain connectors and local files into a single end-to-end workflow	Running each step in a different app manually, then assembling the output yourself



Demo — Pashun Sports Live Sales Dashboard

The Scenario

It's the end of the week. You want a live view of sales performance, stock levels, and the upcoming World Cup match windows — all in one place, opening in a browser, combining data from your local order files, Drive inventory sheet, and the Google Calendar match dates.

Multi-app sales dashboard for Pashun Sports:

Step 1: Read /PashunSports/Orders/Weekly/ – this week's order CSV

Step 2: Read the PashunSports_Inventory.xlsx from Google Drive

Step 3: Read my Google Calendar for upcoming England, Brazil,
and Argentina World Cup matches in the next 14 days

Step 4: Produce a live HTML sales dashboard:

- Total revenue this week with week-on-week comparison
- Top 3 products by units sold (with bar charts)
- Stock alerts: any product below 20 units highlighted red
- Match window section: next 3 fixtures with days until kick-off
and recommended product to feature per match

Save as: /PashunSports/Reports/LiveSalesDashboard.html

(Opens in browser, auto-refreshes data each time opened)

Show plan first.

Cowork handles the cross-app orchestration — local files for orders, Drive for inventory, Calendar for match dates. One brief, one HTML dashboard, no app-switching.

Summary

- Chain multiple connectors and local files in a single task brief with clear step numbers
- Cowork selects the right integration for each step automatically
- Test multi-app workflows manually before scheduling them
- Add 'show plan first' for any multi-app task the first time you run it

Your Turn

Design a task for your own business that spans at least two apps. Write the brief with clear numbered steps. Run it manually first, then consider scheduling it once you've verified the output.

 End of Lesson: How To Build Multi-App Workflows Using Connectors And Files Together

How To Use Skills To Give Claude Domain Knowledge And Best Practices

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Skills are reusable instruction bundles you create yourself. A Skill is a short markdown file that defines exactly how Cowork should handle a specific type of task. Build it once, upload it, and every time that task type comes up, Cowork loads and follows your Skill automatically.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Skills	Reusable task-specific instruction bundles Cowork loads automatically	Re-writing the same instructions every time, getting inconsistent outputs on repeated tasks

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. A Skill is a SKILL.md file — create it in any text editor and save with that filename.
2. Upload it to Cowork: open the Customize section in the Cowork sidebar → Skills → upload your file.
3. Cowork reads the Skill description and applies it automatically when a matching task is detected.
4. You can also reference a Skill explicitly: 'Using the [skill name] skill...'
5. Skills are separate from Plugins — Skills are your own custom instructions; Plugins are pre-built packages we cover in the next lesson.

Demo — Building a Pashun Sports Social Post Skill

What the SKILL.md Looks Like

A SKILL.md file has two parts: a YAML frontmatter block at the top (between --- markers) that tells Cowork when to activate the Skill, and a Markdown body below it that tells Claude how to do the work.

The Frontmatter Block (between --- markers)

This is the metadata Cowork reads to identify and activate the Skill. It must be at the very top of the file.

- name: A unique identifier in lowercase with hyphens (e.g. pashun-social-post). This is how you reference the Skill explicitly in a task brief.
- description: The trigger — Cowork reads this to decide whether this Skill matches a given task. Write it as a sentence starting with 'Use when...' or 'Use this skill when...'. The more specific your trigger, the more reliably Cowork activates it.

 **The frontmatter format (name + description between --- markers) is required for Cowork to detect and load your Skill automatically. The Markdown body below it is entirely up to you — structure it however makes the instructions clearest.**

Best practice: test your description trigger by running a task and checking whether Cowork loads the Skill without you explicitly referencing it. If it doesn't, make the description more specific.

The Markdown Body — Sections You Can Include

Below the frontmatter, you write the actual instructions. Common sections that work well:

- **## Structure** — a numbered list of what Claude should produce and in what order. This is the most important section.
- **## Rules** — hard constraints Claude must follow every time. Word limits, things to always include, things to never do.
- **## Tone** — the voice and style. One sentence of example language often works better than multiple adjectives.
- **## Context** — background about your business or audience that Claude should always have in mind.
- **## Examples** — optional but powerful. Include one good example output. Claude uses it as a reference.

 **You don't need all five sections. A Skill with just ## Structure and ## Rules is often enough. Start minimal and add sections only when you notice inconsistency in the outputs.**

The SKILL.md filename is required. The sections inside it are named by you — there is no rigid schema beyond the frontmatter block.

The SKILL.md for This Demo

```
---  
name: pashun-social-post  
description: Use this skill when creating social media posts  
            for Pashun Sports World Cup 2026 product launches.  
---  
  
# Pashun Sports Social Post Skill  
  
## Structure  
  
1. Hook: 1 punchy line – emotion or match reference (no more than 10 words)  
2. Product callout: name + one key visual detail  
3. CTA: 'Available now at PashunSports.co.uk' or 'Link in bio'  
4. Hashtags: #WorldCup2026 #PashunSports #[TeamName] + 2 trending tags  
  
## Rules  
  
- Instagram: max 150 words total  
- X/Twitter: max 280 characters  
- TikTok: punchy, emoji-friendly, trending hook format  
- Always reference the specific team or tournament moment  
- Never use the word 'amazing', 'incredible', or 'perfect'  
- Tone: fan-first. Knows the sport. Short sentences. Real language.  
  
## Output  
  
Produce an HTML post preview card:  
  
- Tee SVG flat-lay centred on a brand-coloured background  
- Caption below, hashtags beneath  
- Platform label top-right (Instagram / X / TikTok)  
  
Save as: /PashunSports/Marketing/SocialPostPreview_[ProductName].html
```

Using the Skill

```
Using the pashun-social-post skill:
```

```
Create social post preview cards for our England 2026 World Cup Tee.
```

```
Tee details in: /PashunSports/Products/England_2026_Tee_Specs.txt
```

```
Produce cards for Instagram, X, and TikTok.
```

Cowork loads the Skill automatically and produces three visual HTML post preview cards — one per platform. The England tee SVG centred on a navy background, caption laid out below, platform label top-right. Consistent brand output every time, without re-explaining any of the rules.

✓ Summary

- Write a SKILL.md in any text editor: name, description, structure, rules, tone
- Upload via Cowork sidebar → Customize → Skills
- Cowork applies it automatically when a matching task is detected
- Build one Skill per repeated task type — social posts, reports, email drafts
- Skills are your own custom instructions — Plugins (next lesson) are pre-built packages

🎯 Your Turn

Identify the most repeated writing task in your own work. Write a basic SKILL.md with: name, description, structure (3–5 steps), and 3 rules. Upload it and run one task using it.

✓ End of Lesson: How To Use Skills To Give Claude Domain Knowledge And Best Practices

How To Extend Cowork Using Plugins From The Marketplace — And Build Your Own

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Plugins bundle Skills, connectors, slash commands, and sub-agents into a single package. Install a plugin and Cowork behaves like a specialist for that role — a marketing plugin knows campaign briefs, a finance plugin knows invoices. This lesson covers how to install plugins, use them, customise them, and build your own from scratch.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Plugins	Install pre-built domain expertise or build your own custom plugin	Building all your own Skills from scratch when a plugin already has best-practice workflows built in

What a Plugin Contains

A Plugin is a bundle of up to four component types. You don't need all four — a plugin with just Skills works fine.

Skills (domain knowledge)

Markdown files that give Claude procedural knowledge — what to do, in what order, and what good output looks like for a specific task type. Skills inside a plugin load automatically when a relevant task is detected.

Slash Commands (user-triggered actions)

Slash commands are explicit shortcuts that trigger a specific workflow. Type / in the Cowork task input to see available commands from your installed plugins. Slash commands are faster than describing a task — one keystroke kicks off a defined sequence.

Example: the Marketing plugin includes a command /marketing:social-caption. Typing it in the Cowork input immediately runs the social caption workflow.

```
In the Cowork task input, type:
```

```
/ marketing:social-caption
```

```
Then add your context:
```

```
Product: Golden Boot 2026 England tee
```

```
Platform: Instagram and X
```

```
Tone: fan-first, World Cup excitement
```

Connectors (tool integrations)

A Plugin can bundle the connectors it needs — so when you install a Sales plugin, it might automatically connect Claude to your CRM or email tool.

Sub-Agents (specialised agents)

A Plugin can include one or more sub-agents — specialised Claude agents trained for a specific domain. Unlike Skills (which load knowledge), sub-agents take a task end-to-end with deep domain expertise.

The Plugin File — What You Actually Upload

- A .claude-plugin/ subfolder containing a plugin.json manifest — this is required.
- A skills/ folder (optional) — contains your Skill .md files. One file per Skill.
- A commands/ folder (optional) — contains your slash command .md files.
- An agents/ folder (optional) — contains your sub-agent .md files.



The plugin.json manifest is the only required file. Everything else is optional. A minimal plugin is just .claude-plugin/plugin.json plus a skills/ folder.

To package: zip your plugin folder → rename the .zip extension to .plugin → upload via Cowork → Customize → Plugins → +.



Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop → Cowork tab → click 'Customize' in the left sidebar.
2. Click 'Plugins' to open the marketplace.
3. Browse available plugins. Click any to see what it includes. Click 'Add plugin' to install.
4. Once installed, use a plugin's slash commands by typing '/' in the Cowork task input.
5. To customise an installed plugin: click the plugin → 'Customize' → Claude walks you through adapting it.
6. To upload a plugin you've built: Plugins → '+' → 'Upload plugin file' → select your .plugin file.



Demo — Using and Creating a Plugin for Pashun Sports

Part 1: Installing and Using the Marketing Plugin

Using the Marketing plugin:

Create a product launch brief for our 'Golden Boot 2026' England tee.

Source file: /PashunSports/Products/GoldenBoot_Specs.txt

Output:

- 3 social media caption options (Instagram, X, TikTok)
- 1 email subject line and preview text
- 1 hashtag set for the World Cup campaign

Save to: /PashunSports/Marketing/GoldenBoot_Launch_Brief.docx

Part 2: Building a Custom Pashun Sports Plugin

Plugin folder structure:

pashun-worldcup-plugin/

.claude-plugin/

plugin.json ← the plugin manifest

skills/

social-post.md ← reuse the Skill from Lesson 27

product-description.md ← new Skill for written descriptions

```
plugin.json:
{
  "name": "pashun-worldcup",
  "description": "World Cup 2026 content for Pashun Sports.",
  "version": "1.0.0"
}
```

Package and Install Your Plugin

1. Zip the plugin folder:

On Mac: right-click → Compress

On Windows: right-click → Send to → Compressed folder

2. Rename the zip file extension from .zip to .plugin

e.g. pashun-worldcup-plugin.plugin

3. In Cowork → Customize → Plugins → '+' → 'Upload plugin file'

Select your .plugin file.

4. Your plugin appears in the Customize → Plugins list.

Type '/' in any Cowork task to see your plugin's skills.

Use the Plugin Create Tool

Cowork also includes a built-in 'Plugin Create' plugin that walks you through building a custom plugin via conversation — no file editing required:

```
Using the Plugin Create plugin:
```

```
I want to build a plugin for Pashun Sports that handles:
```

1. Writing product descriptions for World Cup merchandise
2. Creating social media posts for product launches
3. Generating email campaign copy for our subscriber list

```
Walk me through building it.
```

✓ Summary

- Find plugins in Cowork sidebar → Customize → Plugins → marketplace
- Use slash commands from installed plugins by typing '/' in any Cowork task
- Customise any plugin by clicking it → Customize — Claude adapts it to your workflow
- Build your own: create a folder with plugin.json + skills/ → zip → rename .plugin → upload
- Use the Plugin Create plugin for a guided, conversation-based build process

🎯 Your Turn

Install one plugin from the marketplace relevant to your own work. Run a task using it. Then use Plugin Create to start building a custom plugin for one task type that matters to your business.

✓ End of Lesson: How To Extend Cowork Using Plugins From The Marketplace — And Build Your Own

How To Use Sub-Agents To Handle Specialised Tasks End-To-End



Intro — What We're Doing Today

Sub-agents are specialised agents bundled within Plugins. When you install a Plugin, its sub-agents become available — each one trained on a specific domain and able to take a task from brief to completion without you managing the steps.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Sub-Agents	Specialised agents from Plugins that handle specific task domains end-to-end	Getting generic outputs because Cowork lacks domain depth for specialist tasks



Demo — Pashun Sports: Customer Order Confirmation Email

The Scenario

An order has just been placed. You need a personalised HTML order confirmation email — the kind of thing the customer receives immediately after buying. It needs to pull the customer's name, product, quantity, and delivery estimate from the order file, and wrap it in branded Pashun Sports design. The Marketing sub-agent handles this end-to-end.

```
Using the Marketing plugin sub-agent:
```

```
Read the order file: /PashunSports/Orders/Daily/ORD-20260611.txt
```

```
Produce a personalised HTML order confirmation email:
```

- Branded header with Pashun Sports name
- Greeting using the customer's name from the order file
- Order summary: product name, qty, price, order number
- Delivery estimate: 3-5 business days
- SVG flat-lay of the product ordered
- Footer with social links and contact email

```
Save as: /PashunSports/Marketing/OrderConfirmation_ORD-20260611.html
```

```
(This is the customer-facing email — open in browser to preview)
```

The Marketing sub-agent knows how branded customer emails should be structured, what tone to use, and what a good order confirmation looks like — you don't need to explain any of that in your brief. Every student has received an email like this. Seeing Cowork produce it from a raw order file in seconds lands immediately.

Sub-Agents vs Skills

	Sub-Agent (from Plugin)	Skill (your own)
Built by	Anthropic or partners	You
Setup	Install Plugin — sub-agent included	Write SKILL.md, upload to Cowork
Domain depth	Deep expertise built in	Whatever you define
Best for	Marketing, Finance, Legal, HR — specialist domains	Your own repeated task types



Summary

- Sub-agents come bundled with Plugins — install the Plugin to access them
- Reference in your brief: 'Using the Marketing plugin sub-agent...'
- Sub-agents have domain expertise built in — you don't need to explain the domain
- Use sub-agents for specialist work; use your own Skills for your repeated task types

Your Turn

Install a Plugin with a sub-agent relevant to your own work (Finance, Operations, Marketing). Run a real task using that sub-agent. Note what it does that a generic Cowork task would miss.

 End of Lesson: How To Use Sub-Agents To Handle Specialised Tasks End-To-End

How To Use The Customize Section To Manage Skills, Plugins And Connectors In One Place



Intro — What We're Doing Today

As you add Skills, Plugins, and Connectors, you need one place to manage them all. The Customize section in the Cowork sidebar is that place. This lesson shows you how to navigate it and keep your Cowork environment organised.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Customize Section	Central hub for managing all Skills, Plugins, and Connectors in Cowork	Skills conflicting, not knowing which plugins are active, connectors not showing in tasks



Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop → Cowork tab.
2. In the left sidebar, click 'Customize'.
3. You'll see three sections: Skills, Plugins, and Connectors.
4. Skills: view, enable/disable, or remove uploaded Skill files.
5. Plugins: view installed plugins, browse marketplace, manage or remove.
6. Connectors: view all connected apps, connect new ones, or disconnect.
7. Changes take effect immediately in your next Cowork task.



Demo — Organising Pashun Sports' Cowork Environment

Skills Active

- ✓ pashun-social-post
- ✓ pashun-product-description
- ⏸ pashun-worldcup-plugin (paused — updating)

Plugins Active

- ✓ Marketing plugin
- ✓ Finance plugin
- ✓ pashun-worldcup (custom — built in Lesson 28)
- ☐ Legal plugin (not installed)

Connectors Active

- ✓ Gmail
- ✓ Google Drive
- ✓ Google Calendar
- ✓ Claude in Chrome
- ☐ Microsoft 365 (not connected)
- ☐ Slack (not connected)

📌 **Keep the Customize section clean. If you have two Skills that both match the same task type, Cowork may apply the wrong one. Disable Skills you're not using to avoid conflicts.**

✓ Summary

- Customize section is in the Cowork sidebar — click to expand
- Manage Skills, Plugins, and Connectors from one central view
- Disable Skills you're not using to prevent conflicts
- Changes are immediate — active settings apply to your next task

Your Turn

Open the Customize section in your own Cowork. Review what Skills, Plugins, and Connectors are active. Disable anything you don't currently need. Make sure your most-used tools are connected and enabled.

 **End of Lesson: How To Use The Customize Section To Manage Skills, Plugins And Connectors In One Place**

How To Build Live Dashboards And Trackers That Auto-Refresh With Your Data

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Live Artifacts are dashboards and trackers that connect to your files and apps and auto-refresh with current data whenever you open them. For Pashun Sports, it means a live sales dashboard that pulls from your order files, inventory, and Google Calendar every time you open it.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Live Artifacts	Create dashboards and trackers that auto-refresh from files and connectors	Manually updating a report every morning, having a dashboard that's stale the moment you close it

What a Live Dashboard Looks Like



Pashun Sports — Live Sales Dashboard

247 Orders This Week £18,340 Total Revenue £74.25 Avg Order Value 3 ⚠ Flagged Orders

Top Products This Week:

1. England 2026 World Cup Tee (White) 89 units
2. Brazil Training Tee (Yellow) 62 units
3. Argentina Fan Tee (Blue) 41 units

Upcoming Match Windows:

England vs Group B — 11 Jun — 4 days away → Feature: England Tee
Brazil vs Group F — 14 Jun — 7 days away → Feature: Brazil Tee

⚠ Low stock alert: Argentina Fan Tee — 18 units remaining

Auto-refreshes from /PashunSports/Orders/ each time you open this file.



Demo — Pashun Sports Live Sales Dashboard

Create a live sales dashboard for Pashun Sports.

Data sources:

- /PashunSports/Orders/ — read most recent weekly CSV on each refresh
- /PashunSports/ — inventory spreadsheet for stock levels
- Google Calendar — upcoming World Cup match dates and fixtures

Dashboard should show:

- Orders this week (count and revenue)
- Top 3 products by units sold with bar charts
- Stock levels — flag anything below 20 units in red
- Upcoming match window: next 3 fixtures, days until kick-off, recommended product to feature per match
- Orders needing attention (cancelled, returned, payment failed)

Format: HTML dashboard file saved to:

/PashunSports/Reports/LiveDashboard.html

(open in any browser — auto-refreshes each time opened)

Other Live Artifact Ideas for Pashun Sports

- World Cup countdown tracker — days until each group stage game + stock level alert per related tee
- Customer feedback tracker — pulls from Gmail connector and refreshes daily
- Campaign milestone tracker — live RAG status board for the marketing team
- Supplier status dashboard — outstanding invoices and delivery status in real time



Live Artifacts connect to your files and apps — they're not static documents.

They refresh with current data on open. The data source stays where it is; the artifact reads it fresh each time.

Output is an HTML file you open in any browser.



Summary

- Ask Cowork to 'create a live dashboard' and define your data sources and metrics
- Live Artifacts auto-refresh from your connected files and apps each time they open
- Output is an HTML file you can open in any browser — no separate app needed
- Works with local files, connectors (Gmail, Drive, Calendar), or a combination



Your Turn

Identify one metric you check manually every day in your own business or project. Ask Cowork to build a live dashboard for it — connecting to the file or app where that data lives. Open it tomorrow and verify it refreshes automatically.



End of Lesson: How To Build Live Dashboards And Trackers That Auto-Refresh With Your Data

How To Let Cowork Control Your Screen When No Connector Exists

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Computer Use lets Cowork navigate your screen directly — clicking, typing, and interacting with apps just like you would. When there's no connector for a tool you need, Computer Use is the fallback. Cowork always tries connectors first, then browser control, then screen control as a last resort.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Computer Use	Cowork controls your screen to interact with apps that have no connector	Manually doing repetitive GUI tasks, data entry, or multi-step web workflows with no connector available

How to Enable Computer Use

Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Make sure you have the latest version of Claude Desktop (claude.com/download).
2. In Claude Desktop, click your initials (bottom-left) → Settings.
3. Click 'General' under the 'Desktop app' section.
4. Find 'Computer use' and toggle it on. Click 'Turn on' to confirm.
5. On macOS: grant Accessibility and Screen Recording permissions when prompted.
6. System Settings → Privacy & Security → Accessibility → add Claude Desktop → toggle on.
7. System Settings → Privacy & Security → Screen Recording → add Claude Desktop → toggle on.
8. Restart Claude Desktop after granting Screen Recording for the permission to take effect.
9. On Windows: the Linux VM handles sandboxing — no additional OS permissions needed.
10. Computer Use is available on Pro and Max plans only (not Team or Enterprise at this time).

How Cowork Chooses Its Tools

 Cowork always tries the most precise tool first:

1. *Connectors (Gmail, Drive, Slack) — fastest and most reliable*
2. *Browser control via Claude in Chrome — for web-based tasks without a connector*
3. *Screen control (Computer Use) — for desktop apps and sites with no other path*

Use Computer Use only when steps 1 and 2 don't cover the task.

Demo — Three Pashun Sports Computer Use Workflows

Workflow 1 — Updating a Spreadsheet in a Tool You Already Have

You manage inventory in a Google Sheet that doesn't have a Sheets connector set up. Computer Use opens Chrome, navigates to your sheet, and updates it.

```
Using Computer Use:

Open Chrome and go to docs.google.com/spreadsheets

Find my spreadsheet called 'PashunSports_StockLevels'.

For the following products, update the stock count column:

    England 2026 Tee (White): 145 units

    Brazil Fan Tee (Yellow): 88 units

    Argentina Training Tee: 62 units

Show me what you plan to do before starting.

Confirm the change for each row before saving.
```

Workflow 2 — Uploading a File to a Supplier Portal

Your supplier KitPro has a web portal for purchase orders. No connector exists for it.

Using Computer Use:

Open Chrome and go to kitpro.com/supplier-portal

(I will enter my login credentials when prompted.)

Navigate to 'Upload Purchase Order'.

Upload /PashunSports/Suppliers/KitPro_PO_Apr2026.pdf

Save the confirmation number once upload completes.

Workflow 3 — Automated Form Filling: VAT Return

You need to submit a VAT return via HMRC's online portal. Cowork reads your VAT summary spreadsheet and fills in every field automatically — you review the completed form and click Submit yourself.

Using Computer Use:

Read /PashunSports/Reports/VATSummary_Q1_2026.xlsx

Open Chrome and go to gov.uk/vat-returns

Fill in the VAT return form using the figures from the spreadsheet:

- Box 1: VAT due on sales (from spreadsheet)
- Box 4: VAT reclaimed on purchases (from spreadsheet)
- Box 6: Total value of sales (from spreadsheet)
- Box 7: Total value of purchases (from spreadsheet)

Show me the completed form before I submit anything.

I will click Submit myself — do not click it.



This is the kind of task everyone has done manually — filling in the same numbers from a spreadsheet into an online form. Cowork does it for you. You stay in control of the final submit.

 Computer Use has no sandbox between Claude and your applications.

Claude sees your screen via screenshots to navigate. It asks permission before accessing each new app.

Always include 'show me your plan before starting' and 'confirm before final action'.

Do not use unsupervised for banking, making purchases, or publishing public content.

 Summary

- Enable: Settings → General (under Desktop app) → Computer use → Toggle on
- macOS: grant Accessibility and Screen Recording in System Settings → restart the app
- Cowork uses Computer Use only as a last resort — connectors and Chrome come first
- Always include plan review and step-by-step confirmation for Computer Use tasks
- Available on Pro and Max only — not Team or Enterprise currently

 Your Turn

Identify one task you do in a web portal or desktop app that has no Cowork connector. Try it with Computer Use — ask Cowork to walk through it step by step, pausing for your approval at each action.

 End of Lesson: How To Let Cowork Control Your Screen When No Connector Exists

How To Use Computer Use Safely And Know When To Fall Back On It

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Computer Use is powerful — but it's a fallback, not a default. This lesson gives you the decision framework for when to use it vs a Connector, and how to use it safely so you stay in control of everything it touches.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Computer Use Safety & Judgment	Know when to use Computer Use vs a Connector, and how to stay safe	Using Computer Use for tasks that have a Connector, or using it unsafely on critical systems

Decision Framework: Connector or Computer Use?

Use a Connector when...	Use Computer Use when...
The app has a connector in the marketplace	No connector exists for the app or portal
You need fast, reliable, repeated access	The task is one-off or low-frequency
You're building a scheduled workflow	The task requires navigating a visual UI
The task involves reading structured data	You need to fill a form or upload a file to a portal

Safe Computer Use Rules

- Always include 'show me what you plan to do before starting' in Computer Use briefs
- For submit, purchase, or publish actions — tell Cowork to pause and wait for your manual confirmation
- Don't give Computer Use access to banking, password managers, or accounts where errors are irreversible
- Test Computer Use tasks on non-critical data first before using on live systems
- If something looks wrong mid-task — type 'Stop' immediately
- Use 'denied apps' in Settings → General to block specific apps from Computer Use

Demo — Safe Computer Use for Pashun Sports

Using Computer Use — with full approval flow:

Open Chrome and go to docs.google.com/spreadsheets.

Show me a screenshot of what you see before doing anything.

Tell me your plan. Wait for my confirmation before each step.

Do not click Save until I explicitly confirm each row change.



Summary

- Default to Connectors — use Computer Use only when no Connector covers the task
- Always include 'show plan first' and 'pause before final action' for Computer Use tasks
- Block sensitive apps via Settings → General → Denied apps
- Never use Computer Use unsupervised on banking, purchasing, or public publishing
- Type 'Stop' at any time to halt a Computer Use task mid-execution



Your Turn

Review three tasks you might consider using Computer Use for. Which could be handled by a Connector instead? For the one that genuinely needs Computer Use, write a safe brief with explicit approval checkpoints at each step.



End of Lesson: How To Use Computer Use Safely And Know When To Fall Back On It

How To Use Dispatch To Assign Desktop Tasks From Your Phone

 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Dispatch lets you assign tasks to Cowork from your phone. Your desktop is running Claude. You send a task from the Claude mobile app — Cowork picks it up and executes on your machine. Come back to finished work.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Dispatch	Send tasks to your desktop Cowork from your phone via QR code pairing	Having to be at your desk to trigger Cowork, tasks waiting until you return

 Where To Find This in Cowork

1. Open Claude Desktop. In the left sidebar under Cowork, click 'Dispatch'.
2. Click 'Get started' on the Dispatch feature page.
3. Toggle on 'Keep desktop awake' to prevent your computer sleeping during remote tasks.
4. Toggle on file access permissions for the folders you want Dispatch to use.
5. A QR code appears on screen — this is your pairing code.
6. On your phone: download the Claude app (App Store or Google Play). Sign in with the same account.
7. Open the Claude mobile app. Tap 'Dispatch' in the sidebar.
8. Tap 'Pair with your desktop' and scan the QR code shown on your desktop.
9. Click 'Finish setup' on your desktop. You are now paired.
10. The pairing persists — you only need to scan the QR code once.
11. Dispatch is available on Pro and Max plans (paid personal accounts only).

 Demo — Using Dispatch for Pashun Sports On The Go

Scenario 1 — Morning Briefing From Your Phone

You're commuting. You want the Pashun Sports daily briefing ready by the time you arrive at the office. Type this in the Dispatch chat on your phone:

```
Run the daily order briefing for Pashun Sports.  
Read today's order export from /PashunSports/Orders/Daily/  
Save the briefing to /PashunSports/Reports/Daily/ as usual.
```

Scenario 2 — Triggering a Report While Away from Your Desk

Type this in the Dispatch chat on your phone:

```
Generate the Week 18 supplier cost report from the files in  
/ PashunSports/Suppliers/Invoices/Wk18/  
Save to /PashunSports/Reports/SupplierCosts_Wk18.xlsx  
Message me when it's done.
```

Dispatch + Computer Use

If your Dispatch task requires Computer Use — navigating a website or desktop app — Cowork can use your computer on your behalf while you're away. You receive a notification when done or when it needs your input.

⚠ Your desktop must be on and Claude Desktop open for Dispatch to work.

Dispatch gives your phone remote control of everything Cowork has permission to access.

Review your folder access and connectors before using Dispatch — anything Cowork can access, Dispatch can trigger.

Available on paid personal accounts (Pro, Max). Not available on Team or Enterprise at this time.



Summary

- Desktop: Cowork sidebar → Dispatch → Get started → QR code appears
- Mobile: Claude app → Dispatch → scan QR code → paired
- Scan once — pairing persists across sessions
- Your desktop must be on and Claude Desktop open for tasks to execute
- Pro and Max plans on paid personal accounts only



Your Turn

Set up Dispatch on your phone and desktop. Send one test task from your phone while your desktop is running. Verify the task executes and you can see the result in the Dispatch chat on both devices.



End of Lesson: How To Use Dispatch To Assign Desktop Tasks From Your Phone

How To Set Up Pairing And Get Results Without Being At Your Desk

Intro — What We're Doing Today

Dispatch creates a single persistent conversation thread that syncs between your phone and desktop. You start a task from your phone, your desktop runs it, and you see the results on either device.

Feature	Why We Use It	What It Solves
Cross-Device Pairing via Dispatch	Keep your mobile and desktop Claude sessions in sync via a persistent thread	Tasks siloed to one device, not being able to check Cowork results from your phone

How the Persistent Thread Works

Once paired, Dispatch creates one shared conversation that appears on both your phone and desktop. Messages you send from your phone appear on your desktop. Claude's responses appear on both. Context carries across the whole session — Claude remembers what you're working on regardless of which device you message from.

Demo — Pashun Sports Remote Workflow

A Full Day Without Being at Your Desk

Time	What You Do (Phone)	What Cowork Does (Desktop)
8:00am	Send daily briefing task via Dispatch	Reads order files, generates briefing, saves to / Reports/
10:30am	Ask for World Cup stock summary	Reads inventory file, generates summary, saves output
1:00pm	Trigger weekly sales report	Pulls week's data, generates report, saves to / Reports/Weekly/
3:00pm	Ask for Gmail customer feedback digest	Searches Gmail, summarises themes, saves to / Reports/
5:00pm	Check Dispatch thread on phone	Results from all tasks visible in the shared thread

Checking Results on Your Phone

All task results appear in the Dispatch thread on your phone — summaries, file locations, and any questions Cowork needs answered. You can reply from your phone to redirect or approve the next step.

 **Dispatch is a remote control, not cloud computing.**

Your desktop must be awake and Claude Desktop open for tasks to run.

If your laptop goes to sleep, Dispatch goes dark — tasks resume when it wakes.

Tip: use 'Keep desktop awake' in Dispatch settings, or plug in your laptop before stepping away.

Summary

- Dispatch creates one persistent conversation thread across phone and desktop
- Task results appear in the shared thread — check from either device
- Context carries across devices — Claude remembers what you're working on
- Your desktop must be awake and Claude Desktop open for remote tasks to execute
- Reply from your phone to redirect, approve, or ask follow-up questions

Your Turn

Design one full day's remote workflow using Dispatch — tasks you could trigger from your phone while away from your desk. Set it up and run the first task from your phone. Verify you can see the result in the Dispatch thread on both devices.

End of Lesson: How To Set Up Pairing And Get Results Without Being At Your Desk